

ANDREA SOFFICI

IT Architect | Systeme Engineer & Middleware Specialist

Core Banking · Post-Merger Integration · Legacy Decommissioning · Legal Archiving & Compliance

PROFILE

IT architect, System Engineer and Middleware Specialist with more than twenty-five years in banking, insurance and telecommunications and on keeping mission-critical platforms available under pressure.

Since 2022 embedded in the IT function of Credit Suisse Italy and, after the merger, of UBS Italy: IBM WebSphere administration for the core banking platform, migration of application deployments between the two groups, systematic decommissioning of legacy applications and delivery of the legal archiving, legal hold and access migration workstreams.

Fourteen years at Primeur, IBM Premier Partner, as architect and specialist for banking, insurance and telecommunications clients, including official IBM WebSphere course delivery.

IBM Certified Advanced System Administrator for WebSphere Application Server Network Deployment.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- **CS-to-UBS core banking migration - WebSphere workstream:** administered the WAS Network Deployment cell architectures of both groups (Deployment Manager, Node Agents, clustered servers), migrated application deployments from Credit Suisse to UBS infrastructure and tuned JVMs and thread pools through the high-volume cutover windows.
- **Legacy decommissioning:** systematic retirement of Credit Suisse legacy applications, with data extraction and validation before shutdown, controlled shutdown of the WAS instances hosting them and progressive consolidation of the remaining estate without loss of availability.
- **Legal archiving and legal hold:** mass loading and verification of historical data into the ELAR electronic legal archive, onboarding and file format validation for TransArch, and Legal Hold procedures on the HAWK anti-money-laundering database with database dumps, checksums and Azure-based long-term retention.
- **Automation and repeatability:** wsadmin scripting for automated configuration deployment and verification across the merged environments, and bash tooling for the decommissioning workflows.
- **IBM recognition:** Certified Advanced System Administrator for WebSphere Application Server ND, instructor of the official IBM courses WA761 and WA661, and on-call WebSphere problem solving for Italian banks.
- **Sector breadth:** banking (Credit Suisse, UBS, Deutsche Bank, Intesa Sanpaolo, UniCredit, UBI Banca), insurance (Fonditalia, Aviva, RSA, Genialloyd, Cardif BNP, AXA Tech), telecommunications (Vodafone, Telecom Italia, H3G) and Poste Italiane.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Middleware IBM WebSphere Application Server ND and XD 4 to 9 · IBM HTTP Server · WebSphere Portal, Process Server and SOA products · IBM MQ Series and MQSI · Oracle / BEA WebLogic 6 to 12c · Apache · Tomcat · JBoss · Tuxedo · Primeur Spazio Suite

Banking Programmes Post-merger integration · legacy application decommissioning · legal archiving (ELAR, TransArch) and legal hold · identity and access management · CS-to-UBS access migration · regulatory reporting extracts and reconciliation · IT landscape governance and application lifecycle management

Platforms IBM i (AS/400) 9.3 and 9.4 · AIX and PowerP · Solaris · HP-UX · Red Hat Enterprise Linux · SUSE Linux Enterprise · Windows Server · Azure Storage · FreeBSD, OpenBSD · Cisco routers

Databases Oracle 8i to 11g and RAC · IBM DB2 7 to 10 · Microsoft SQL Server · MySQL

Scripting & Development Shell (ksh, bash), awk, sed · Python and Jython · Jacl and wsadmin · Perl · SQL · Java and J2EE · PHP · C · XML, XSLT, UML · ESQL for MQSI

Security SSL/TLS certificate management · LDAP integration · IAM policies, provisioning and role-based access · secure file transfer (SFTP) and B2B onboarding · server hardening · CrowdStrike · penetration testing tools (Nessus, Nmap, Tcpdump, Tripwire, Iptables, PGP/GPG)

Performance JVM tuning · thread and connection pool optimisation · log and root cause analysis · LoadRunner, Apache JMeter, OpenSTA, Siege, HP BAC

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assignments from 2022 at Credit Suisse and UBS are delivered as an employee of Project S.r.l., an Italian IT consultancy, in part as subcontractor to prime vendors. Clients are listed as the primary reference for the work performed. Earlier roles are direct employment.

UBS Italia — Milan, Italy

Swiss banking group — post-merger integration and compliance

IT Architect — Legacy Systems Decommissioning & Compliance Support

Jan 2025 – present

- Leads technical initiatives for legacy system retirement and regulatory compliance in the merged entity, coordinating with product ownership and development teams on the Credit Suisse core banking platform for Italy.
- Maintains the production WebSphere Application Server environments of the consolidated banking platform: day-to-day administration, monitoring and troubleshooting of the clusters still hosting Credit Suisse applications under decommissioning.
- Manages application server availability through cutover: JVM and connection pool optimisation for migrating applications, log and root cause analysis on retirement and archival issues, and controlled shutdown of the WAS instances hosting decommissioned applications.
- Runs the legal archive workstream: loading and verification of massive volumes of historical data, completeness and accessibility checks, and quality controls against regulatory retention requirements.
- Leads TransArch onboarding: file upload testing, format validation and landing zone configuration for transaction archiving.
- Architected and implemented the Legal Hold procedures for the HAWK anti-money-laundering database - database dumps, checksums and validation to preserve evidence integrity - on Azure-based archiving infrastructure, and produces the CSV extracts used for reconciliation, audit and regulatory reporting.
- Coordinates the CS-to-UBS user access migration, including incident suspension procedures, provisioning workflows and role-based access certification for the merged user base.
- Technical environment: IBM WebSphere Application Server ND 8 and 9 on IBM i 9.3/9.4, IBM HTTP Server, IBM MQ Series, IBM AS/400, Linux (RHEL, SLES), Windows Server, Azure Storage, bash scripting.

Credit Suisse Italia / UBS Italia — Milan, Italy

Swiss banking groups — merger integration

IT Architect — Core Banking Migration Specialist & IBM WebSphere Expert

Jan 2024 – Dec 2024

- Led the technical architecture and migration planning to transfer the Credit Suisse Italia core banking platform onto UBS Italia infrastructure, covering customer accounts, transaction history and product configurations with full data integrity and no service interruption.
- Administered the WAS Network Deployment cell architectures of both banks and migrated application deployments from the Credit Suisse to the UBS estate, with full testing and validation.
- Reconfigured SSL certificates, LDAP integrations and security settings for the merged entity; executed WAS version upgrades and configuration alignment as part of infrastructure standardisation.
- Developed wsadmin scripts for automated configuration deployment and verification across the merged environments, and performed intensive log and root cause analysis during cutover windows.
- Managed the IFMS interfaces between the two platforms: version control, quality assurance and release management, remediation of expired integrations, large-scale data migration with delta processing, naming convention standardisation and transformation rules aligning Credit Suisse structures to UBS standards.
- Produced the current-state, migration and target-state technical documentation in Confluence and CATI, including permissions and system configurations for compliance and knowledge transfer.
- Managed CrowdStrike security alerts and whitelisting to preserve endpoint protection throughout the migration.

Credit Suisse Italia — Milan, Italy

Global bank

IT Architect & IBM WebSphere Application Server Specialist

Jan 2022 – Dec 2023

- Ran the production WebSphere Application Server Network Deployment environments supporting critical banking operations: cell administration, JVM tuning, thread and connection pool configuration, performance monitoring and advanced troubleshooting.
- Managed SSL certificates, LDAP integration and security configuration in line with banking security standards.
- Established and maintained the IT landscape governance framework and the enterprise application registry, tracking software assets, versions, dependencies and lifecycle stages, and coordinating updates, patches and end-of-life transitions.
- Designed and implemented IAM policies and procedures, coordinating provisioning, authentication and authorisation workflows against banking regulation and internal security policy.
- Architected and deployed secure file transfer (SFTP) for critical data feeds with external counterparties, including B2B onboarding with SNEM and other banking networks, IP whitelisting, endpoint validation and end-to-end encryption.

Primeur S.r.l. — Milan, Italy

IT company, IBM Premier Partner

Customer & Product Manager · ICT Architect · WebSphere and WebLogic Specialist · Oracle DBA Aug 2007 – 2021

- Owned the technical and commercial relationship with a portfolio of major accounts: Intesa Sanpaolo, UniCredit, UBI Banca, Poste Italiane, EDS for ENI, Aviva, RSA, Genialloyd, AXA Tech, Cardif BNP and Quinn Direct (Ireland).
- Designed administrative architectures, high availability environments, clusters and application servers; planned the security of application infrastructures; automated administration and migration through scripting.
- Logging, tracing, debugging and troubleshooting of J2EE applications; performance, design, tuning and scalability work.
- Team leader on several projects with responsibility for people; Oracle DBA across projects; product management and Oracle migration of the proprietary Spazio suite.
- Delivered the official IBM WebSphere courses WA761 (Advanced Administration) and WA661 (Scripting and Automation), and acted as HP products specialist.

Earlier career — Milan and Turin, Italy

Telecommunications, banking, insurance, automotive and public sector

Architect, Performance Engineer, Project Manager and System Administrator roles 1996 – 2007

- Italtel / One-Ans for Telecom Italia (2006-2007) - architect, performance engineer and product management on two parallel programmes: the VoIP element manager, with Oracle and Unix tuning and the migration to a new Java-based application, and the CICCX surveillance and fault management platform with Cisco Info Center and Netcool/Impact.
- Vodafone / Altran (2005-2006) - application support engineer and WebLogic specialist on call centre CRM applications in production, with 24x7 second-level support, tuning and system integration.
- Iveco / GlobalValue - IBM (2004-2005) - MQSI and MQ engineer for the adaptation layer between SAP and the customised legacy systems handling warranties, on AIX and Linux.
- H3G Italy - IBM (2002-2004) - quality assurance programme manager for the content management and games platforms, and analyst programmer on the UMTS architecture with Oracle administration, certificate authority management and BEA administration.
- Deutsche Bank - Accenture (2001-2002) - Unix and Oracle administrator on the trading platform for equities and fixed income, with first to third level support, security integration and monitoring.
- Dots (2002) - systems engineering and architecture project manager, team leader of ten people, on banking applications for equity trading and fixed income products.
- Fondiaria Assicurazioni - EDS (2000-2001) - project manager for the northern Italy team migrating the agency network to Windows 2000; HI-TEK (2000) - partner; CSG (1998-2000) - internet project manager; ASL 1 Lombardia (1996-1997) - software developer and trainer.

EDUCATION

Degree in Economics — Università Commerciale Luigi Bocconi, Milan

CERTIFICATIONS

- **2009 — IBM Certified Advanced System Administrator** - WebSphere Application Server, Network Deployment V6.1
- **2007 — IBM Certified System Administrator** - WebSphere Application Server, Network Deployment V6.0
- **2005 — LabVIEW Machine Vision & Image Processing** - National Instruments, Milan
- **IBM workshops and Proof of Technology:** SOA with WebSphere Process Integration (2007), WebLogic to WebSphere migration (2008), WebSphere Application Server ND V7.0 (2008), WebSphere Service Registry and Repository V6.3 (2009)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Instructor of official IBM WebSphere courses; member of the Global WebSphere Community.
- Active member of Informatici Senza Frontiere, a non-profit organisation, with project responsibility.
- Long experience of multicultural delivery: the Deutsche Bank Maxblue programme was run in English and German with colleagues from across Europe and India.

LANGUAGES

Italian Native speaker

English Reading excellent · Writing and speaking good

